LESSON 6

Twinkle, Twinkle

An old French tune that Mozart loved: he wrote twelve variations on it, the same tune twelve new ways. The words are Jane Taylor's, from 1806.

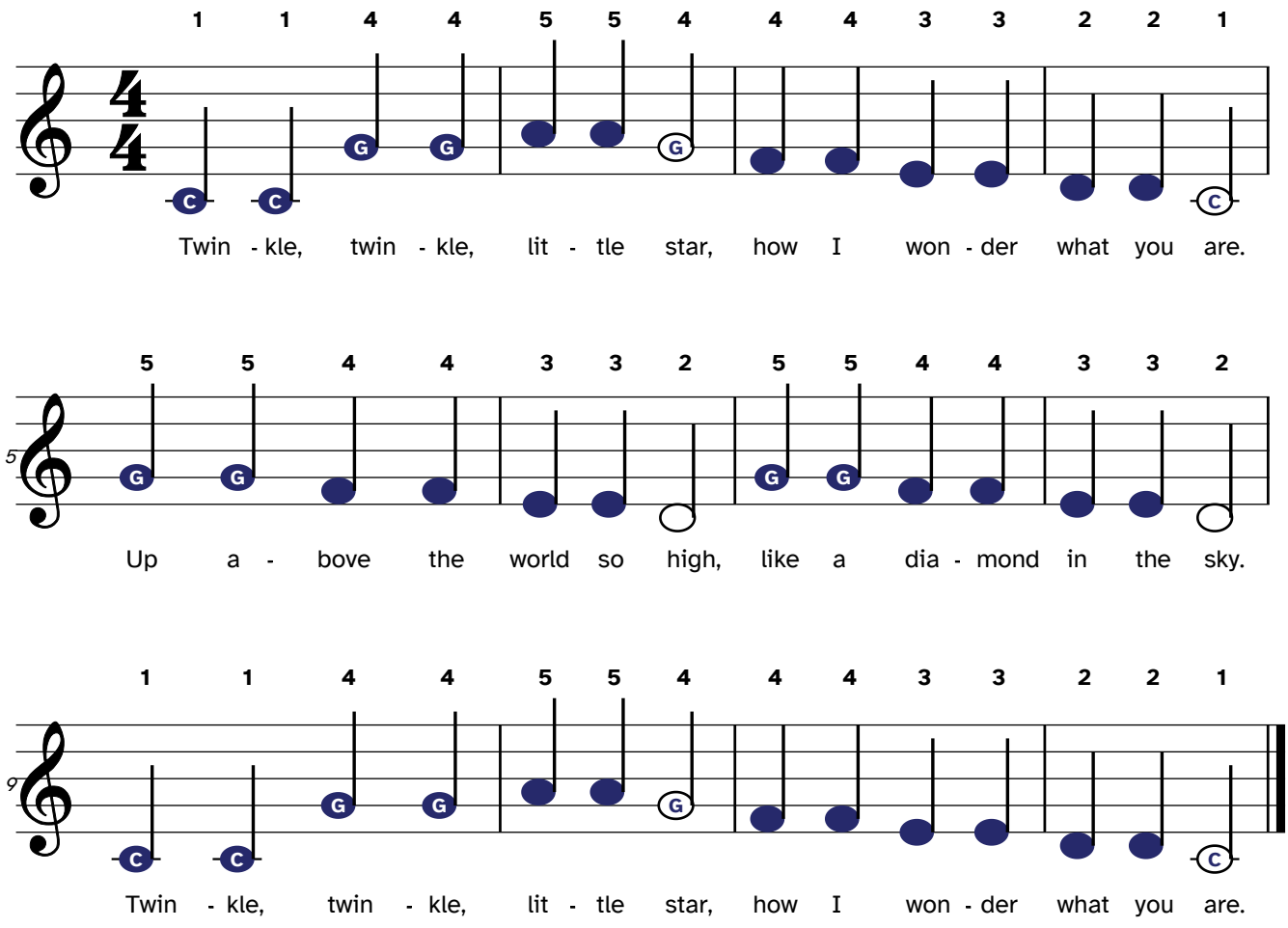
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **Be Mozart:** he played this tune twelve ways. Play it as written, then every note twice: *twin-kle-twin-kle*.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words.

Your hand: thumb on C, 4 on G, 5 on A for *twinkle, little star*, then back to the C position. Only C and G keep their letters.

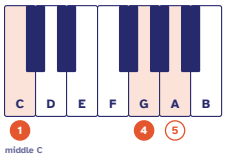


- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words
- [ ] Opened the hand

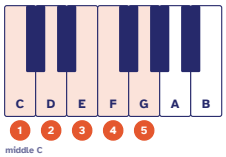
2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

BARS 1–2 · THE HAND OPENS



BARS 3–8 · THE C POSITION



NEW IN THIS SONG

The hand opens. Thumb on C, then 4 on G and 5 on A: the hand stretches. From bar 3 it closes back to the C position.

More in the Handbook: Pitch 1 and 2, for the note A

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

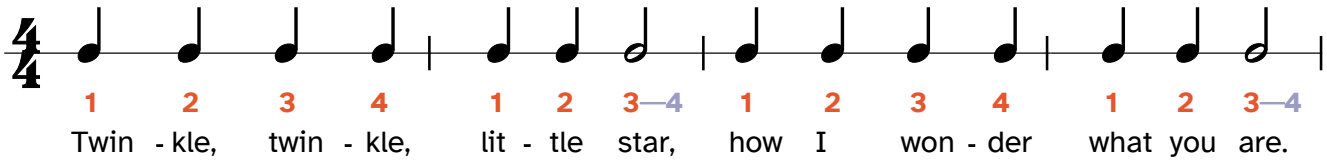
Top 4: four beats in every bar.
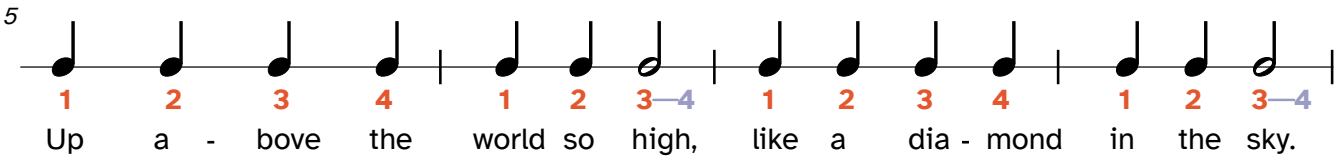
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk
1 beat
●

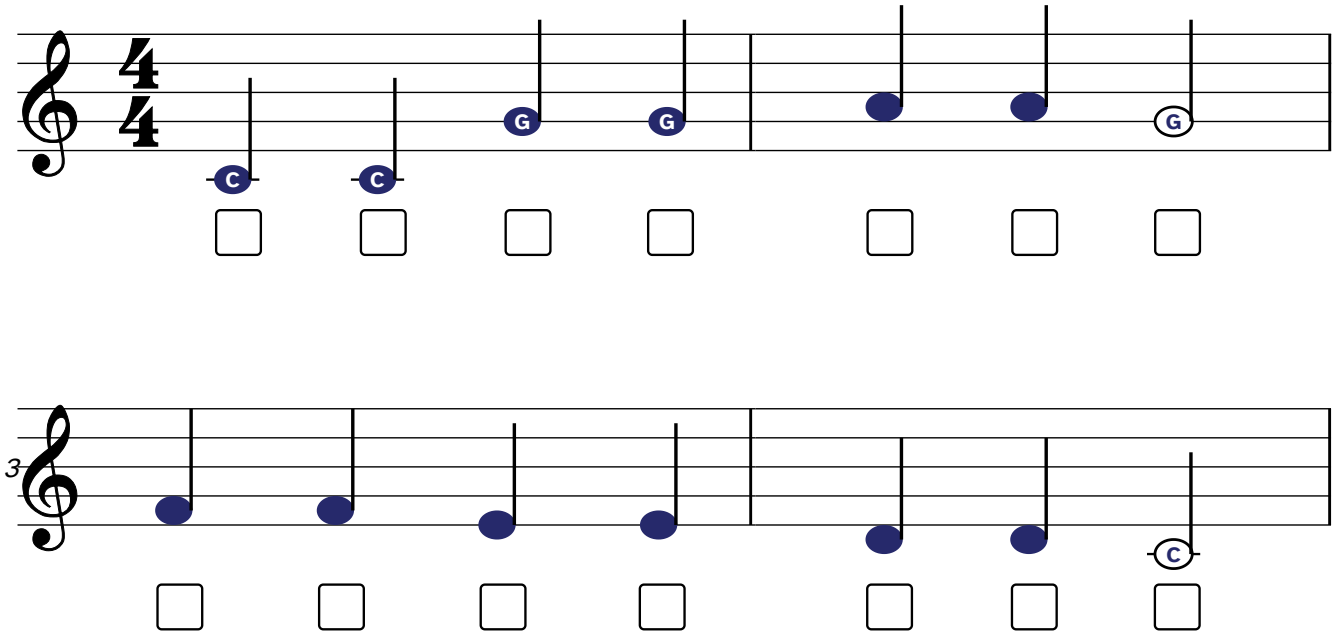
minim: hold
2 beats
●●





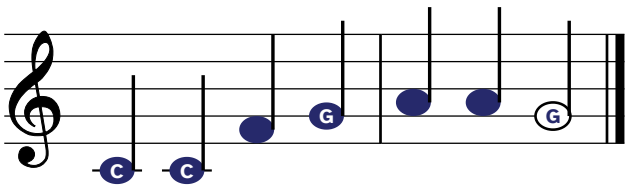
THE NOTES

Only C and G are named. Write the others under their notes: count up or down from C and G, and find the new A.



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

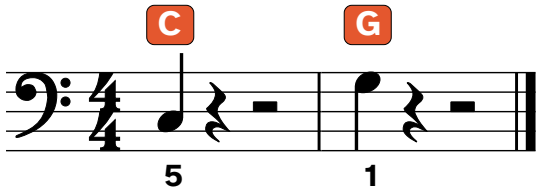
3 Lead sheet

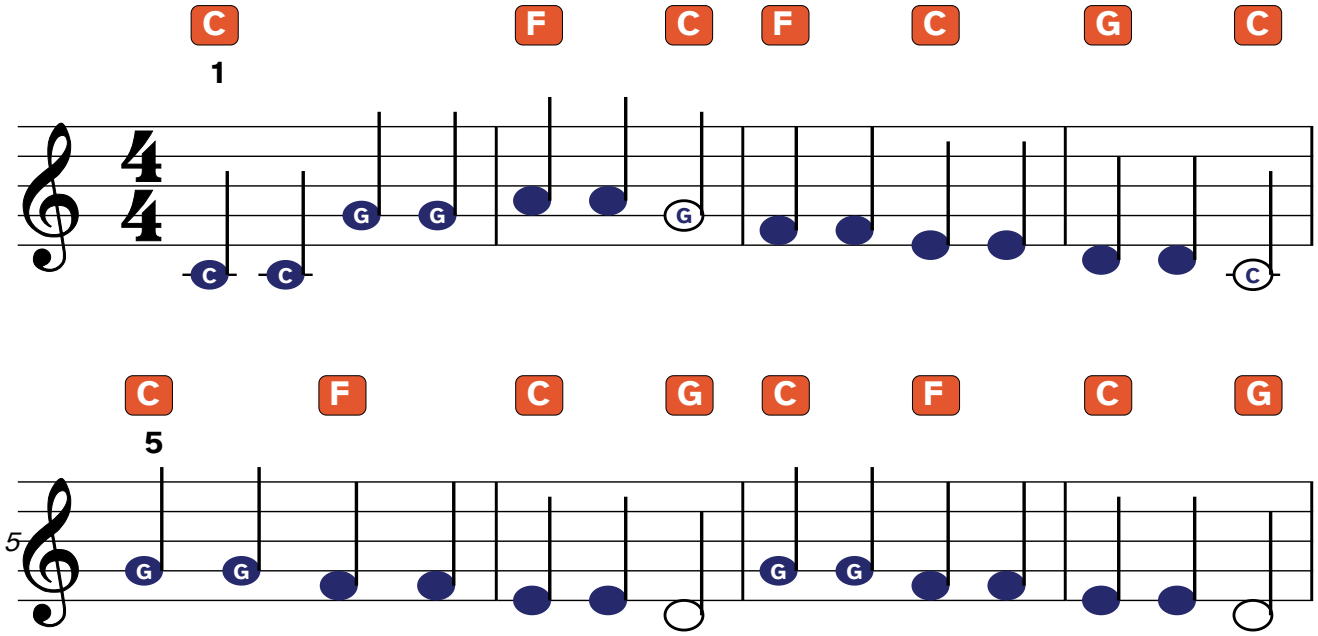
The tune and its chord names. Some bars have two names: tap each root where its name sits, beat 1 or beat 3.

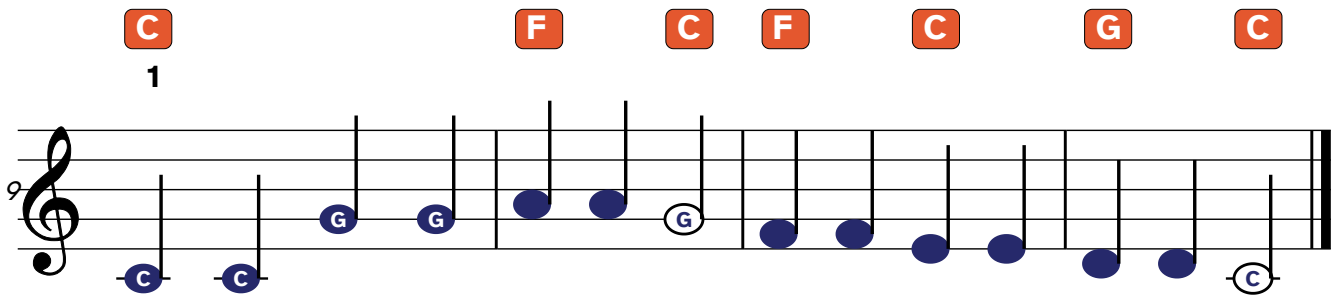
TAP THE ROOT

The root is the chord's own letter: C for C, G for G. Play it once, on beat 1, and let it ring.

C F G







1 Tune alone, right hand

2 Left hand alone: tap the roots while the recording plays the tune

3 Together, slowly

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words

☐ I can open my hand: 4 on G, 5 on A

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the roots				

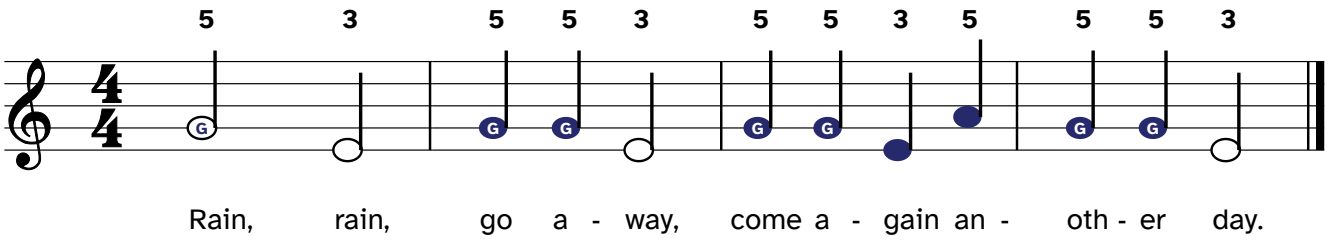
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways: the rain rhyme, then hands that take turns, a peek at Lesson 7.

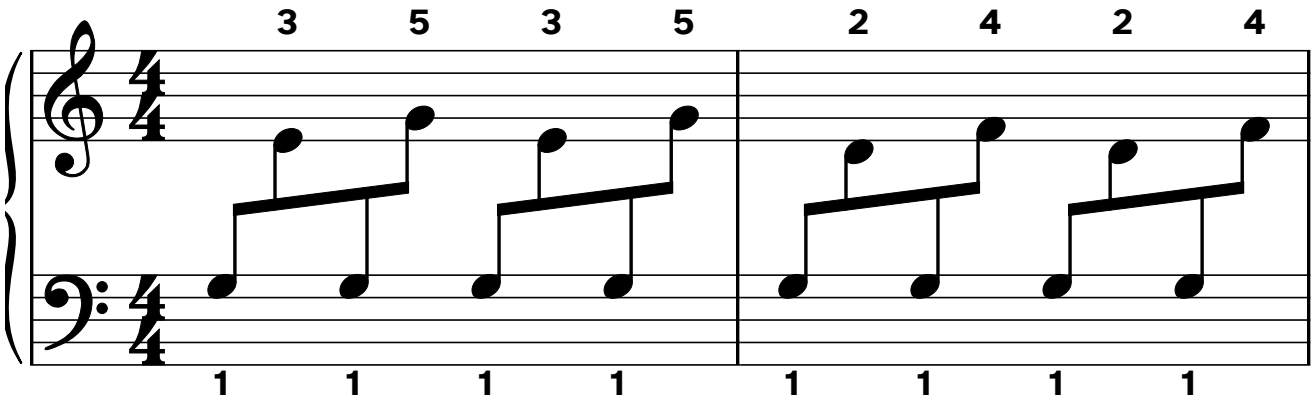
RAIN, RAIN, GO AWAY

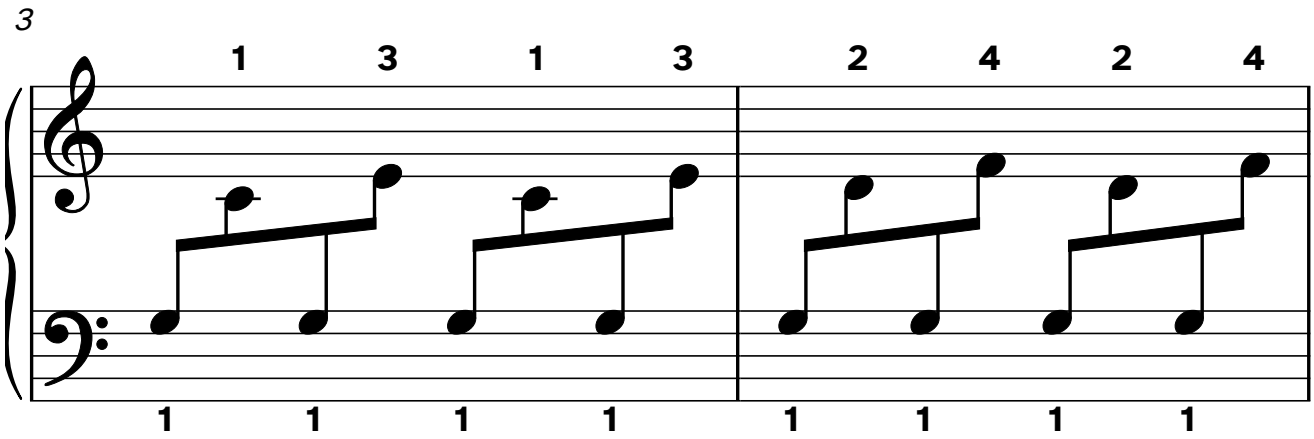
The old rhyme to send the rain away: G and E, and 5 reaching to A on *an-other*.

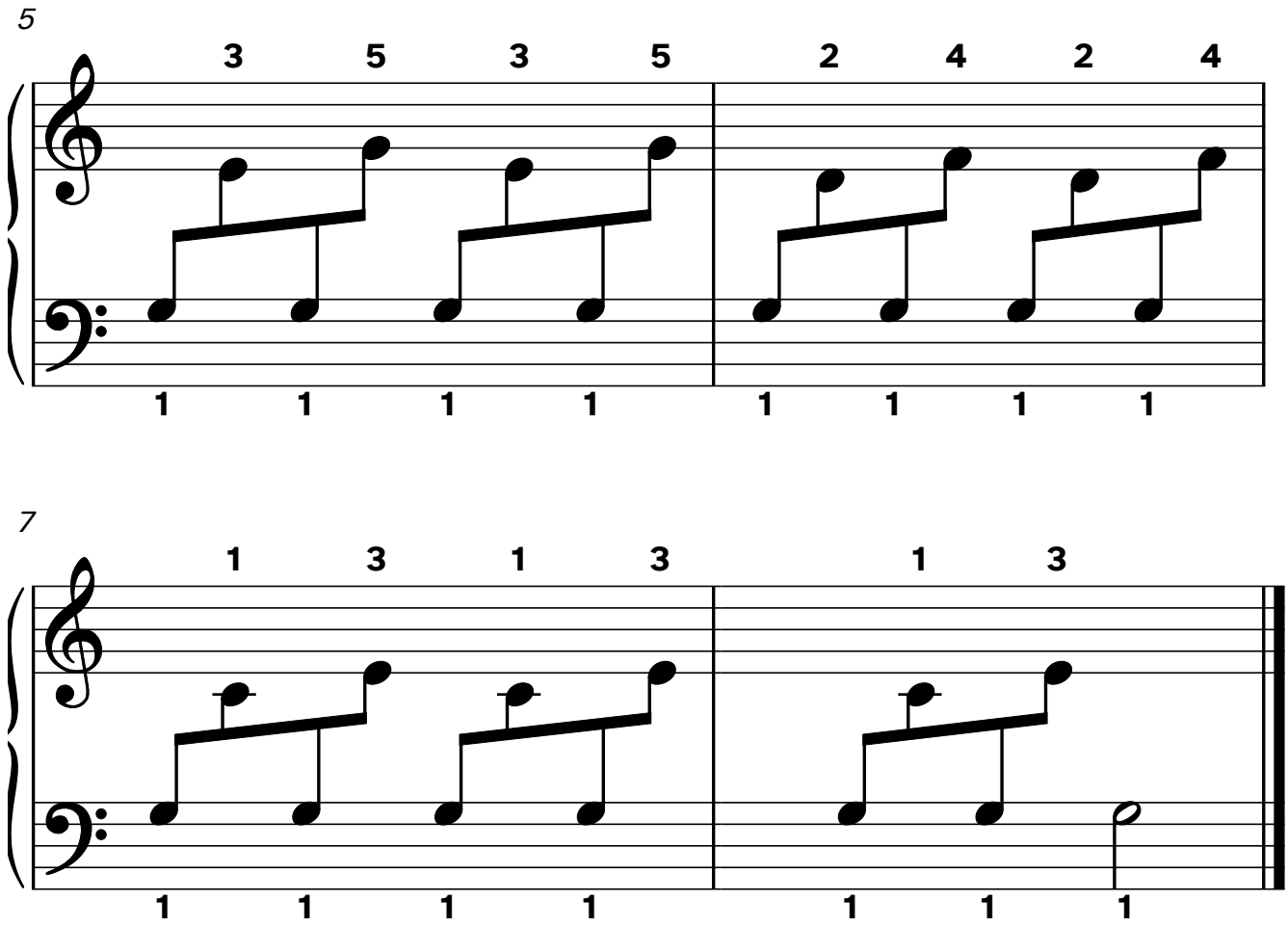


FALLING LEAVES

Gentle and swaying. Hands take turns around middle C: the left thumb stays on G the whole time, while the right hand keeps one shape, two keys apart, and steps down a key each bar, then back up.







MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- ☐ **Mozart's way: every note twice, twin-kle-twin-kle**
- ☐ **Dreamy: slow and soft, with the harp**
- ☐ **Heartbeat: the left hand taps low C on beat 1 of every bar**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. The whole song, twice
3. Left hand: tap the roots (page 3)
4. One variation of your own

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Rain, Rain** ☐ **Played Falling Leaves**